Beyond Compliance: Six-Indicator Self-Assessment

Your AI governance framework already tells faculty, students, and peers whether your institution is reacting to this moment or building the capacity to adapt. Use this page to read it the way they do.

How to use it

1. Open your institution's public AI framework (policy, guidelines, and any linked standards).
2. For each indicator, compare what you find with the early and maturing signs, then mark where it sits: Early, Developing, or Maturing.
3. Pick one indicator to change in your next revision, and name who needs to be in the room to change it.

The six indicators

Indicator	Early sign	Maturing sign	Where mine sits (E, D, or M)
Default	Says "no unless approved"	"Yes, with conditions," or the instructor decides	
Reach	Stops at academic integrity	Also covers equity and access, ethics, data privacy, and who governs	
Owner	No named owner, or a one-time task force	A named, standing group is responsible	
Currency	Undated, or never revisited	Dated, with a visible revision or a plan to revisit	
Support	Rules only	Training, AI literacy programming, or tools	
Audiences	One message for everyone	Separate guidance for students, faculty, staff, and researchers	

My one indicator

The indicator I could change in our next revision	
Who needs to be in the room to change it	
My first step, and by when	

Two things to keep in mind

- Relabeling a default without building behind it changes the signal, not the substance. Prohibition is not the problem; what separates frameworks is what gets built behind the default.
- Maturing is never complete. Kane and colleagues use "maturing," not "mature," because "the process is never complete" (Kane et al., 2019, p. 46). A gap is a starting point, not a grade.

Sources: Brazelton, G. B. (under review), Beyond compliance: AI governance frameworks as signals of institutional digital maturity (400-institution document analysis). Kane, G. C., Phillips, A. N., Copulsky, J. R., & Andrus, G. R. (2019), The technology fallacy, MIT Press. From the AAC&U Conference on AI and Higher Education session, October 29, 2026. More at bluebrazelton.com.